Marvel files for bankruptcy.

13 years later, Disney pays about $4 billion.

To survive, it rented out its heroes.

X-MEN

Film rights to Fox

SPIDER-MAN

Film rights to Sony

Blade made a fortune. Marvel didn't.

BLADE, U.S. BOX OFFICE

About $70M

MARVEL'S TAKE

About $25,000

Stop renting the characters out. Make the movies yourself.

A loan backed by superheroes.

$525M

Merrill Lynch financing, with 10 Marvel characters as collateral

Iron Man wasn't in the deal. Marvel backed it anyway.

It had just won the character's film rights back.

Iron Man grossed over $500 million worldwide.

Own studio

Own character

Own the upside

Bankrupt to $4 billion.

- **1996** Bankrupt
- **2005** $525M loan
- **2008** Iron Man
- **2009** Disney, ~$4B

Licensing pays once. Ownership compounds.

1. List what you rent out today
2. Find one asset you could own
3. Keep the upside, not just the fee